

Don't JUNK that PC!

There are lots of things you can do with that old *dabba* of yours. Here are a few...

Two laws govern how soon a computer becomes obsolete—Moore's Law and Parkinson's Law of Data. Read up on these two, and you'd want to junk your four-year old PC already. But hang on—old computers are not worthless. In fact, those who know the worth of an old computer would only be too happy to buy a second-hand one. So what exactly do these folks do with their outdated machines?

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The most common use for older computers, especially amongst small firms and SoHo users, is account maintenance. Another common use is word processing. Minimum system requirements for Windows 95 is a 386DX processor, 4 MB of RAM and 50 MB of hard disk space. Windows 98, too, needs only a minimum of a 486 processor with 24 MB of RAM and 205 MB of hard disk space.

For word processing and other office applications, install Microsoft Office 97 on the old computer. MS Office 97 requires a minimum of a 486 Processor, 8 MB of RAM and 73 MB of hard disk space. Once these are installed, you can do all your word processing on the old computer, and free up your newer computer for other, more important uses: Games!

For accounting, use software such as Tally's older versions, 4.5 for example. This version was discontinued nine years ago, but runs on a 386. Look for other software that runs on a low-end machine: there are many sites that give you information about these software, and many discussion forums too. Try www.old-computers.com for one.



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